

JULY 2020

Dhul Hijj Special

EDUCATION

Enlighten and Empower

OUR VISION

To uplift and transform the Muslim society from their educational poverty in the light of true knowledge which leads one back to Allah

ORGANIZATION'S UPDATE

*Alhumdulillah, up till now we have been able to assist 24 students in continuing their academic journey. We have taken 3 new cases in the month of July. A total of Rs. 51,880 has been collected and Rs. 65,100 has been spent on the educational needs of the beneficiaries. Along with financial support, we also provide mentorship to all the students for career and personal counselling. For more detailed information of all the cases **click** on the link shared at the end of this page.*

BREAKING BARRIERS WITH NAZIMA

Nazima is one of 4 siblings living in Secunderabad, Telangana. Her father works as a painter and her mother works as a domestic help. She'd received funds in the amount of 7.4K on 16th July and cleared her dues from Grade 5 on the 17th. She's been promoted to Grade 6 and her classes are being conducted online.

What this issue contains

- Hadith of the month
- Student Feature Story
- This month's read

PEARLS OF WISDOM

Abu Dharr narrated that the Messenger of Allah said :

*"Your smiling in the face of your brother is **charity**, commanding good and forbidding evil is **charity**, your giving directions to a man lost in the land is **charity** for you. Your seeing for a man with bad sight is a **charity** for you, your removal of a rock, a thorn or a bone from the road is **charity** for you. Your pouring what remains from your bucket into the bucket of your brother is **charity** for you."*

Jami` at-Tirmidhi 1956

Book 27, Hadith 62

English translation : Vol. 4, Book 1, Hadith 1956

THE LEGACY OF PROPHET IBRAHIM AS

The month of Dhul Hijjah in the Arabic calendar is one of the four sacred months in the Islamic calendar. It is in this month that we honour the extraordinary legacy of the family of the father of the prophets, Prophet Ibrahim AS. The exemplary character of Ibrahim AS is not just understood through his story but also through the beautiful duas that he makes through every phase of his life. He was one of the most tested prophets in terms of challenges he faced with his father, with a tyrant, with his wives and children.

Some of the duas he made have been mentioned below.

Our Lord, I have settled some of my descendants in an uncultivated valley(Makkah) near Your sacred House, our Lord, that they may establish prayer. So make hearts among the people incline toward them and provide for them from the fruits that they might be grateful.

(14:37)

And disgrace me not on the day when they are raised, the day on which neither wealth nor children will avail, except one who comes to Allah with a sound heart. (26:87-89)

Understanding the life of Ibrahim AS plays a powerful role in understanding the rituals of Hajj. Through these rituals, pilgrims are able to connect themselves to a shared history and to the legacy of Ibrahim AS and his family. Part of the unique story of Hajj presented in the Qur'an is that Ibrahim AS was the first man tasked to proclaim the duty of Hajj to others (Qur'an 22:27). Yet, Ibrahim AS is also largely presented in the Qur'an as a man with nearly no followers besides his own immediate family.

The Qur'an refers to Ibrahim as a **"nation unto himself,"** referencing his isolation (Qur'an 16:120).

Yet the Abrahamic call for Hajj is somehow answered generations afterwards, with millions of people from every corner of the world striving to follow his footsteps. It represents a message of hope, optimism, and trust in God and reveals how the most unlikely outcomes can be achieved with God's Will.

The Hajj also represents the ability to connect to a larger nation and community. That millions of people, male and female, past and present, from different races, ethnicities, and ages can synchronize rites and rituals, driven by common purpose, provides the pilgrim with a powerful experience of shared brotherhood and kinship that cannot be experienced otherwise

Each aspect of the Hajj symbolizes something spiritual that connects the soul to the remembrance of the afterlife(*refer source article*). We strive to grow morally and spiritually, and reach our full potential while struggling against the trials and tribulations that befall us. Through the symbolic language of rituals, we discover a layer of meaning in our lives that speaks to our core sense of self: who we are, where we have come from, and for what purpose we exist. **The greatest journey is the spiritual journey towards God, to achieve knowledge of Our Creator and the physical journey of the Hajj encapsulates many powerful rituals that awaken us to our relationship with the Divine and with one another.**